

users estimate relevance based on a quick scan of content on search engines and Web sites, the wrong title tag could kill your chances of getting hits.

Huge Pages

Considering that India is still to achieve the mass adoption of broadband, sites with large file sizes for pages are frowned upon. When you get data transferred to you at around 5 KBps, the average 100 KB page takes 20 seconds to load. This is already too long in terms of visitors' patience, and the only reason most sites get away with is because here in India we're used to waiting for pages to load. However, if you have a site that has a 500 KB start page, this translates to a minimum of 100 seconds of waiting for the page to load-unacceptable!

On an average, try to keep pages as small as possible—less than 100 KB. This will ensure that users have a better experience at your site. One site that overwhelms you with huge page sizes is www.bengalboy.com, where the average page is over 4 MB. This PG13-rated site has ridiculous quantities of images, and ends up taking over 15 minutes to load on dial-up connections—preposterous.

Flash Designs

Although the use of Macromedia Flash has revolutionised the way content can be stored on your site and displayed to visitors, it is another bandwidth hog. Since Flash is generally used to compress videos or animations to display on Web pages, the file sizes are always large. Even simple button animations can add a few KBs here and there, which can total up to a lot.

You also need to remember that text almost always loads before graphics, and most users will scan through whatever appears on your site first and decide whether the content is what they are looking for. Even though you may have relevant content neatly displayed using a fancy Flash links menu, many users may not stick around long enough to see this.